

TO: Portland Public Schools Board of Directors

FROM: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

DATE: February 20, 2025

SUBJECT: Senior Chief Salary Schedule

BOARD GOAL 1, 2, 3 & 4: Academic Achievement

PPS STRATEGIC PLAN PRIORITY 3: Professional Excellence and Support

One of my goals in my first year as Superintendent is creating a leadership structure that best supports our schools, staff, and students. I am excited to move forward on the first steps in a cabinet reorganization that will streamline workflows, consolidate efforts, and strengthen our leadership.

For your consideration is the addition of a Senior Chief salary level. Although a new layer of leadership is being introduced, the overall restructuring will result in cost savings as we work through our deficit. The Senior Chief level is a fundamental component of the reorganization. While I had initially planned to roll out the complete picture later this spring, I am moving forward on this level early because it directly impacts key reporting structures.

I have asked Dr. Jon Franco to step into the role of Senior Chief of Operations, and Kristina Howard to serve as our new Senior Chief of Academics, effective July 1. A high-level org chart representing this change is below.

Dr. Franco's leadership has been a steady force in our district. His deep understanding of PPS's inner workings and commitment to creating sustainable, student-centered solutions will serve us well as he takes on this expanded role. Moving forward, IT, Athletics, and Operations will report directly to Jon, ensuring a streamlined approach to critical district functions.

Ms. Kristina Howard's passion for education and student success has been evident in every role she has held, and her ability to lead with both strategy and heart has made a lasting impact. In her new role, Academics, Schools, and Student Services will now report directly to Kristina, creating a unified structure that will help drive greater alignment, efficiency, and academic excellence across PPS.

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